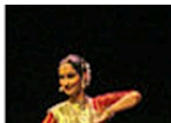


General Knowledge

Art & Culture

STUDY NOTES

Folk Dances of States - I



FOLK DANCES OF STATES - I

Folk dance

- Folk dances are created by individuals to depict the lifestyles of people in a specific country or region.
- These dances are not all ethnic dances, they are **not ceremonial dances** or dances based on rituals.
- Folk dances facilitate the **exploration of India's diverse cultural terrain**.
- The traditions of Tribal and Folk dances of India **vary by state or region** and are based on local mythology and folklore.
- Indian folk and tribal dances are a result of various socioeconomic conditions and long-standing traditions.



Classical Dance v/s Folk Dance

- One prominent aspect of India's diversity is reflected in the realm of dance, with Classical and Folk Dance standing out as two major and distinct dance forms in the country.
- The primary differentiator between Classical and Folk Dances lies in their origins.
- Classical dances, with a history deeply rooted in the Natya Shastra, encompass eight distinct forms, each with its unique elements.
- In contrast, Folk Dances in India emerge from **local traditions**, shaped by the specific state, ethnicity, or geographical region, resulting in a vibrant array of over **100 different folk dances across the country**.
- Folk dances, unlike classical dances, are **spontaneous** and performed by locals with **no formal instruction** and they are restricted to a small group of people or a single venue.
- The knowledge is passed down from generation to generation.

Folk dances of States

Folk Dances of Haryana

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion
Phag Dance	Performed by farmers during Phalgun, with men and women in colourful attire.	Men and Women	Phalgun (spring season)
Saang Dance	Ritualistic folk dance involves cross-dressing and portrays religious stories. Originated by Kishan Lal Bhaat in 1750 AD.	Men (in cross-dress)	General festivals and ceremonies
Chhathi Dance	Romantic dance performed by women on the sixth day after a male child's birth, accompanied by night performances.	Women	On the birth of a male child
Khoria Dance	Jhumar-style dance performed by women in colourful skirts, depicting daily affairs and agricultural work.	Women	Harvest and agricultural work
Dhamal Dance	Performed by Ahir men in a semi-circle, celebrating the harvest and praying to Lord Ganesh and the Holy Trinity.	Men	Harvest season
Daph Dance	Seasonal dance to celebrate a bountiful harvest with drumming and jewellery sounds.	Men and Women	Spring season
Ghoomar Dance	Circular dance performed by girls in a swirling motion, associated with festivals like Holi and Teej.	Girls	Holi, Gangaur Puja, Teej
Jhumar Dance	Performed by young married girls, named after the ornament 'Jhumar'.	Young married girls	Marriage-related celebrations

Gugga Dance	Men dance in the memory of saint Gugga Pir, performed during processions.	Men	Procession in memory of saint Gugga Pir
Loor Dance	Girls perform this dance during Holi, marking the arrival of spring.	Girls	Holi, Rabi crop sowing
Ras Leela Dance	Traditional dance praising Lord Krishna is performed by Braja people in colorful, embroidered costumes.	Men and Women	Devotional events related to Lord Krishna
Chaupaia Dance	Devotional dance where participants carry manjiras (musical instruments).	Men and Women	Devotional ceremonies
Deepak Dance	Devotional dance performed carrying earthen lamps often lasts all night.	Men and Women	Devotional ceremonies
Ratvai Dance	Dance performed during the rainy season, is popular among the Mewatis.	Men and Women	Monsoon season
Been-Bansuri Dance	Accompanied by wind instruments like the been and bansuri (flute), representing devotion and rural life.	Men and Women	Devotional and cultural events

Folk Dances of Andhra Pradesh

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Kuchipudi Yakshagana	A dramatic dance form combining dance and theatre, depicting stories from epics like Ramayana and Mahabharata.	Men and Women	Cultural and Religious festivals	Various regions

Dhimsa	Performed by tribal communities, connected to the worship of deities, especially during festivals.	Tribal Men and Women	Festivals, Harvest Celebrations	Tribal areas
Burrakatha	Storytelling forms combining narration, music, and dance, are popular in rural Andhra Pradesh.	Men	Cultural Performances	Rural Andhra Pradesh
Veeranatyam	Known as the "dance of the brave," is performed in honour of Lord Shiva.	Men	Religious Festivals	Villages of Andhra Pradesh
Kolattam	Stick dance performed by groups, similar to Dandiya, involves rhythmic movements.	Men and Women	Festivals and Social Gatherings	Rural Andhra Pradesh

Folk Dances of Himachal Pradesh

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Nati	Traditional dance is performed in a circular formation, showcasing local culture and attire.	Men and Women	Festivals, Weddings	Entire state
Jhamak	A folk dance performed during festivals, characterized by lively music and vibrant costumes.	Women	Cultural Festivals	Various regions
Sirmouri Nati	A dance from the Sirmour district, often performed during fairs and celebrations, highlighting local traditions.	Men and Women	Local Festivals	Sirmour district

Dhamal	Energetic dance performed during weddings and festivals, involving lively movements and rhythms.	Men	Weddings, Local Festivals	Entire state
Dandras	A traditional dance performed during harvest time, celebrating the bounty of the fields.	Men and Women	Harvest Festivals	Various regions

Folk Dances of Jharkhand

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Jhumar	A dance celebrating harvest, known for its rhythmic movements and festive atmosphere.	Men and Women	Harvest Festivals	Entire state
Chhau	A warrior dance that incorporates martial arts and vibrant masks, is often performed during festivals.	Men	Chhau Mela, Cultural Events	Purulia region
Karam	A dance performed during the Karam festival, celebrating nature and the harvest season.	Men and Women	Karam Festival	Entire state
Mundari	A traditional dance performed by the Mundari tribe, reflecting their cultural heritage and lifestyle.	Men and Women	Cultural Celebrations	Tribal areas
Santhali	A dance performed by the Santhal tribe, characterized by graceful movements and traditional songs.	Men and Women	Festivals, Ceremonies	Santhal Pargana

Folk Dances of Karnataka

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Dollu Kunittha	A drumming dance performed by men, known for its energetic movements and rhythmic beats.	Men	Festivals, Cultural Celebrations	Entire state
Veeragase	A dramatic dance form is performed to narrate the tales of valour and bravery, often during religious festivals.	Men	Religious Festivals	Entire state
Huli Vessa	A dance performed by men dressed as tigers, often during Dasara celebrations, symbolizing strength and courage.	Men	Dasara Festival	Coastal Karnataka
Nagaradhane	A snake dance is performed to honour the serpent god, reflecting cultural beliefs and traditions.	Men and Women	Religious Ceremonies	Various regions
Kunittha	A lively folk dance characterized by group performances, showcasing local culture and traditions.	Men and Women	Local Festivals	Various regions

Folk Dances of Kerala

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Mohiniyattam	A graceful dance performed by women, combining expressive gestures and intricate footwork.	Women	Festivals, Temple Events	Entire state

Kathakali	A classical dance-drama characterized by elaborate costumes and facial expressions, depicting mythological stories.	Men	Festivals, Cultural Events	Entire state
Theyyam	A ritual dance performed in temples, featuring vibrant costumes and storytelling through movement.	Men	Temple Festivals	Malabar region
Kolkali	A group dance performed with sticks, known for its rhythmic clapping and energetic movements.	Men and Women	Harvest Festivals	Various regions
Ottamthullal	A solo dance performed by men, combining dance, drama, and music, often telling stories from mythology.	Men	Festivals, Cultural Celebrations	Various regions

Folk Dances of Madhya Pradesh

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Ghoomar	A folk dance performed by women in swirling movements, celebrating various occasions.	Women	Festivals, Weddings	Entire state
Pandavani	A traditional storytelling dance form narrating the tales of the Pandavas from the Mahabharata.	Men and Women	Cultural Events	Entire state

Matki Dance	A dance performed by women balancing pots on their heads, showcasing grace and skill.	Women	Festivals, Celebrations	Bundelkhand region
Dandaria	A dance performed with sticks symbolizes the celebration of festivals and harvest.	Men and Women	Harvest Festivals	Various regions
Badhai	A joyous dance performed during weddings and childbirth celebrations, marked by energetic movements.	Men and Women	Weddings, Birth Celebrations	Various regions

Folk Dances of Maharashtra

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Lavani	A lively dance form characterized by its powerful rhythm and expressive gestures often performed in folk songs.	Women	Cultural Festivals, Weddings	Entire state
Dholki	A dance performed with dhol (drum), showcasing rhythmic movements and group performances.	Men and Women	Festivals, Celebrations	Various regions
Tamasha	A traditional folk theatre that includes dance, music, and storytelling, often performed during festivals.	Men and Women	Cultural Festivals	Various regions
Koli Dance	A vibrant dance performed by fishermen, showcasing their daily life and struggles.	Men and Women	Local Festivals	Coastal Maharashtra

Fugdi	A traditional dance performed by women in a circular formation, celebrating various occasions.	Women	Festivals, Weddings	Konkan region
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Folk Dances of Manipur

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Manipuri Raas	A dance form dedicated to Lord Krishna, performed with graceful movements and colourful attire.	Men and Women	Festivals, Religious Celebrations	Entire state
Khamba Thoibi	A traditional dance narrating the love story of Khamba and Thoibi, marked by emotional expressions.	Men and Women	Cultural Celebrations	Entire state
Lai Haraoba	A ritualistic dance performed during the Lai Haraoba festival, symbolizing the creation of the universe.	Men and Women	Lai Haraoba Festival	Entire state
Thang Ta	A martial dance form combining dance and combat techniques, showcasing traditional martial arts.	Men	Cultural Events	Entire state
Rasa Leela	A traditional dance-drama depicting the life and exploits of Lord Krishna, performed with elaborate costumes.	Men and Women	Festivals, Religious Events	Entire state

Folk Dances of Odisha

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
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Dalkhai	A vibrant dance performed by young women during the Dussehra festival, featuring energetic movements and singing.	Women	Dussehra Festival	Western Odisha
Jhumar	A popular folk dance performed by both men and women, characterized by circular formations and lively steps.	Men and Women	Harvest Festivals	Various regions
Gotipua	A traditional dance performed by young boys dressed as girls, often depicting the life of Lord Krishna.	Young Boys	Religious Festivals	Coastal Odisha
Sambalpuri	A dance form reflecting the rich cultural heritage of the Sambalpur region, performed to folk songs.	Men and Women	Cultural Festivals	Western Odisha
Chhau	A semi-classical dance combining martial arts and folk traditions, known for its masks and storytelling.	Men	Cultural Festivals	Mayurbhanj, Sundargarh

Folk Dances of Punjab

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Bhangra	A lively and energetic dance performed by men, celebrating the harvest season with joyful movements.	Men	Baisakhi Festival	Entire state
Gidda	A vibrant dance performed by women, characterized by graceful movements and traditional attire.	Women	Baisakhi, Teej Festivals	Entire state

Luddi	A dance performed mainly by men, marked by energetic and rhythmic steps, often during celebrations.	Men	Weddings, Festivals	Entire state
Malwai Gidda	A variant of Gidda performed in the Malwa region, is known for its unique steps and movements.	Women	Local Festivals	Malwa region
Jhumar	A folk dance with joyful movements performed by both men and women, usually in a circle.	Men and Women	Weddings, Cultural Celebrations	Various regions

Folk Dances of Rajasthan

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Ghoomar	A traditional women's dance characterized by graceful twirls and colourful costumes, often performed at festivals.	Women	Weddings, Festivals	Entire state
Kalbeliya	A dance performed by the Kalbeliya community, known for its serpentine movements and vibrant attire.	Women	Festivals, Cultural Events	Entire state
Bhavai	A dramatic dance performed by women balancing pots on their heads, showcasing skills and grace.	Women	Festivals, Celebrations	Entire state
Chari	A dance where women balance earthen pots while dancing, reflecting the traditional lifestyle of Rajasthan.	Women	Festivals, Local Celebrations	Various regions

Kachchhi Ghodi	A folk dance performed on decorated horse-like structures, narrating tales of valour and bravery.	Men	Cultural Festivals	Various regions
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Folk Dances of Tamil Nadu

Dance Form	Description	Performed By	Occasion	Region
Karagattam	A folk dance performed with pots on the head, celebrating the goddess Mariamman.	Men and Women	Festivals, Cultural Events	Entire state
Kuthirai Velakku	A horse dance performed by women symbolizes the worship of the horse as a divine being.	Women	Festivals, Temple Events	Various regions
Silambattam	A traditional martial art form that includes dance movements with sticks, showcasing agility and skill.	Men	Cultural Festivals	Entire state
Otta Kuthirai	A dance performed by a group of men, showcasing traditional movements and cultural themes.	Men	Festivals, Celebrations	Various regions
Mayil Attam	A dance performed by women mimicking peacock movements, celebrating nature and beauty.	Women	Local Festivals	Various regions